Post-production workflow

Created during my full-time role at DramaBox and shared with audio contractors.
Selected guidance for vertical-drama sound production, review and delivery.

01 Validate the turnover

Receive the AAF, reference picture, current notes, music references and schedule. Confirm files open, match the current cut and stay in sync. Flag missing media or version issues immediately.

02 Establish clear dialogue

Clean and balance production dialogue first. Manage noise, level differences and room tone. If a line cannot be repaired adequately, submit an ADR request with timecode and reason.

03 Build sound and music around the story

Support transitions, reveals, action and emotional turns without competing with dialogue. Shape music entrances, exits and episode endings to the cut.

04 Align direction before final polish

When requested, submit selected scenes or episodes as an early review pass. Resolve substantial notes on tone, sound design, pacing and balance before final polishing.

05 Submit a complete QC pass

Provide a low-resolution picture reference with the complete current mix. Check missed moments, dialogue clarity, balance, scene treatment and continuity across episodes.

06 Resolve notes and deliver

Address later notes assigned to sound. Raise unclear instructions or schedule risks with the post team. Export the approved mix and required stems after a full export check.

QC & delivery checklist

The exported result must be reviewed before submission.
Project-specific delivery instructions take priority over the baseline below.

- [ ] **Picture and version**

  Correct cut version; sync throughout; no missing shots, missing audio or accidentally muted sections.

- [ ] **Dialogue and balance**

  Dialogue stays clear and consistent. Music and effects support the scene. Phone, off-screen and other processed voices sound intentional and believable.

- [ ] **Music and continuity**

  Cue changes are clean. Episode endings land with an appropriate tail, button or fade. Sound treatment remains consistent across episodes.

- [ ] **Mix and stems**

  Stems correspond to the approved final mix. Check the exported files, names and settings, rather than relying only on the session.

Baseline delivery package

Audio: Broadcast WAV, 48 kHz, 24-bit, stereo 2.0.
Files: Approved reference video, full mix master and required stems.
Typical stems: Dialogue, FX, background/ambience and music.
Naming: ProjectCode_ProjectName_SND_Date_MIX.wav
Use the project delivery sheet when stem splits or naming differ.

Escalate early: Missing materials, sync or AAF problems, unclear notes, ADR concerns and risks to delivery. Communicate these before they become late-stage revisions.